MONTHLY UPDATE

Morocco: monthly update, September – October 2026

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Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.

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FINANCE
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DPI
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TECHNOLOGY
AI · Innovation ecosystem

CAPACITY
Training and skills · Research institutions

INCLUSION
Access to services · Digital divides

Governance

Legislation and regulation

CIVIL PROCEDURE CODE REQUIREMENT OF AN EMAIL ADDRESS FOR LEGAL-PERSON PARTIES

- **غياب البريد الإلكتروني يعرقل مساطر تحصيل الديون أمام المحاكم التجارية** — Hespress, 13 October 2026

  Casablanca's commercial court of first instance rejected a payment-order application for MAD 376,552 because it omitted the debtor company's email address, applying Article 234 of Morocco's Civil Procedure Code, which requires an email for any legal-person party, Hespress reported on 13 October 2026. Creditors without debtors' email addresses face similar refusals. The order's date is not given.

Data protection

JUDICIAL INVESTIGATION INTO CLAIMED SPYING ON A POLITICAL PARTY'S PHONES

- **النيابة العامة بالدار البيضاء تفتح بحثا قضائيا بشأن ادعاءات التجسس على هواتف حزب سياسي** — Nichan, 14 September 2026

  Morocco's prosecutor general at the Casablanca Court of Appeal ordered a judicial investigation into a party leader's claim that his party's phones were being spied on. The national judicial police will verify the claim, which the prosecution tied to the proper conduct of the elections; the party is not named.

Regional collaboration

ESCWA MEMORANDUM ON DIGITAL GOVERNANCE

- **ESCWA and Morocco Sign Regional Partnership to Advance Digital Governance** — Tech Africa News, 3 September 2026

  The UN Economic and Social Commission for Western Asia and Morocco's minister for digital transition signed a memorandum in Rabat framing regional cooperation on modernising public administration and digital governance reform.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

TACIT-APPROVAL PROPOSAL FOR ADMINISTRATIVE DECISIONS

- **La petite révolution administrative cachée dans le programme de l'Istiqlal** — L'ODJ, 4 September 2026

  Morocco's Istiqlal party proposes in its election programme that, for some procedures, an administration's silence after a set deadline should count as approval, columnist Mamoune Acharki wrote in L'ODJ on 4 September 2026. The programme also proposes fewer prior authorisations, more use of specifications, and faster digitisation of procedures. No list of procedures or deadlines is given.

PUBLIC ARGUMENT OVER THE SPYWARE ALLEGATIONS

- **حداد يفند مزاعم اختراق المغرب لهاتف سانشيز** — Assabah, 8 September 2026

  A Moroccan academic and politician rejected as overstated the July 2026 consortium findings tying Moroccan bodies to the compromise of the Spanish prime minister’s phone.

- **من 'تصفية المنظري' إلى 'بيغاسوس'.. هل يفتح القضاء الإسباني ملف حيجاوي؟** — Hespress, 8 September 2026

  A Moroccan analysis asks why Spanish prosecutors have taken no action against a former intelligence officer since 2010, and whether the spyware row now reopens that file.

Finance

MoUs and other agreements

DIGITAL INFRASTRUCTURE AND CLOUD MEMORANDUM

- **Rabat : signature d’un MoU pour accélérer le développement des infrastructures numériques et du cloud** — PanoraPost, 15 September 2026

  The digital transition ministry and a critical digital-infrastructure supplier signed a memorandum in Rabat on developing digital infrastructure, cloud computing and artificial intelligence.

New investments

INSURANCE TECHNOLOGY AND INCLUSION PROGRAMME

- **InsurTech in Morocco: AfDB backs a programme to modernise insurance** — Canal212, 27 September 2026

  Morocco's insurance supervisor (ACAPS) launched an InsurTech programme with the African Development Bank, a US$680,000 technical assistance package of which the bank gives US$510,000 as a grant and ACAPS US$170,000. Running to early 2027, it begins with a tendered study of regulatory barriers to digital insurance.

DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION ACCELERATION PROGRAM

- **Numérique et climat : le Maroc consolide deux chantiers de long terme avec 567,3 M€** — La Vérité, 4 October 2026

> Morocco's Bulletin officiel of 1 October 2026 published decrees approving two World Bank loans: €218.2 million, signed on 25 June, for the Digital Transformation Acceleration Program, and €349.1 million, signed on 30 June, for climate and risk finance. The digital programme plans a single public services portal and a digital wallet linked to the electronic ID card, with results expected by 2031.

ICT Infrastructure

Data Storage

> ICUDAR DAKHLA GREEN DATA CENTRE

- **Maroc IA 2030 : le Royaume passe de l'ambition a l'action** — LesEco.ma, 10 September 2026

  Morocco's digital transition minister, Amal El Fallah Seghrouchni, presented the operational phase of the Maroc IA 2030 roadmap in Rabat on 8 September 2026. It includes green data centres at Dakhla, a network of regional JAZARI institutes and language models in Darija and Amazigh. Targets for 2030 are MAD 100 billion added to GDP, 50,000 jobs and 200,000 trained people.

> NEXUS ARTIFICIAL-INTELLIGENCE COMPUTE PLATFORM

- **FiveNines Group partners with Nexus Core Systems to develop 20MW data centre in Morocco** — EIN Presswire (FiveNines Group announcement), 7 October 2026

  The UK firm FiveNines Group was appointed to lead design management and procurement strategy for a 20MW AI data centre that Nexus Core Systems plans near Casablanca, Morocco, using Nvidia's Vera Rubin reference architecture. The announcement puts the wider Nexus AI Factory platform's target at 180MW on renewable power. No cost, permit or construction start is given.

DPI

Digital Payments and Fintech

> MEMORANDUM WITH THE UAE CENTRAL BANK ON INTERLINKING PAYMENT SYSTEMS

- **CBUAE, Bank Al-Maghrib sign two MoUs to strengthen supervisory cooperation, Islamic finance** — Eye of Riyadh, 4 October 2026

  Bank Al-Maghrib and the Central Bank of the UAE signed two memoranda in Abu Dhabi. One covers supervisory information exchange and Islamic finance; the other is to explore linking the two countries' instant payment platforms, card switches and financial messaging systems, and to exchange expertise on central bank digital currencies.

> RETAIL CENTRAL BANK DIGITAL CURRENCY (RESEARCH AND PROOF OF CONCEPT)

- **A DSGE Model for a Small Open Economy with a CBDC Option (Bank Al-Maghrib Working Paper)** — Bank Al-Maghrib, 7 October 2026

  A Bank Al-Maghrib working paper dated 7 October 2026, by Michael Kumhof, Mohammed Mikou and Yassine Slaoui, builds an economic model calibrated on Morocco with banked and unbanked households, which can be run with or without a retail central bank digital currency. Under its baseline assumptions, introducing the currency brings modest output gains and modestly better resilience to financial shocks.

- **Monnaie Digitale de Banque Centrale : Enjeux et enseignements pour le Maroc (Document de travail)** — Bank Al-Maghrib, 7 October 2026

A Bank Al-Maghrib working paper on central bank digital currency says a proof of concept built with the IMF and World Bank confirmed that a retail CBDC is technically feasible in Morocco. It reports a cross-border CBDC experiment under way with the Central Bank of Egypt and treats any issuance as long-term and gradual. The views are the authors', not the bank's.

- بنك المغرب يصدر وثيقتي عمل حول العملة الرقمية للبنك المركزي — Assabah, 9 October 2026

  Morocco's central bank published two research working papers on a central bank digital currency, one on the stakes and lessons for Morocco and one a modelling exercise. It presents them as its researchers' work, shared for debate.

CASH IN CIRCULATION AND CARD USE

- زحف "الكاش" يمتحن نجاعة خطط "بنك المغرب" لتوسيع الأداء الرقمي — Hespress, 13 October 2026

  Cash in circulation in Morocco reached 550.3 billion dirhams at the end of August 2026, up 12.1% since the end of 2025, according to Bank Al-Maghrib data. Cash withdrawals made up 85% of the value of card transactions in 2025, even as bank cards rose 7.7% to 23.5 million. The central bank is expanding merchant acceptance, a unified QR payment platform and digital public payments.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

ELECTRONIC FILING OF ELECTION CANDIDACIES

- انتخاب أعضاء مجلس النواب.. إيداع التصريحات بالترشيح إلى غاية 9 شتنبر (بلاغ للداخلية) — Assabah, 4 September 2026

  Morocco's interior ministry said candidacies for the 23 September 2026 House of Representatives election must first be filed online on elections.ma, open from 31 August until noon on 8 September, before original files are lodged with the authorities by noon on 9 September. Equipped rooms are provided at prefectures and provinces, and campaigning runs from 10 to 22 September.

IDARATI NATIONAL PORTAL, NEW VERSION

- **Idarati : vers une administration plus proche, proactive et centrée sur le citoyen** — Ministère de la Transition Numérique et de la Réforme de l'Administration (MTNRA), 18 September 2026

  The Moroccan digital transition ministry's own communiqué on the relaunched Idarati portal presents it as a proactive, user-centred single access point to administrations' digital services.

- **Lancement de la nouvelle version du portail national Idarati, pour une administration plus proche et plus intelligente** — Assahafa, 18 September 2026

  Morocco's digital transition ministry launched a new version of the Idarati portal, giving access to 874 online services organised around user journeys and 2,533 published administrative acts, with a feedback function, an accessibility redesign and a marketplace of AI solutions. The ministry presents it as groundwork for Idarati X.0.

Technology

AI

AI MADE IN MOROCCO ROADMAP

- **Madame Amal El Fallah Seghrouchni a preside, le 8 septembre 2026 a Rabat, une presentation consacree a l'etat actuel de la feuille de route 'Maroc pour l'intelligence artificielle 2030'** — Ministere de la Transition Numerique et de la Reforme de l'Administration, 8 September 2026

Morocco's minister for digital transition, Amal El Fallah Seghrouchni, chaired a review in Rabat on 8 September 2026 of the Maroc pour l'intelligence artificielle 2030 roadmap. Its targets are 100 billion dirhams added to GDP, 50,000 jobs and 200,000 certified people by 2030; progress was reported on sovereign cloud and data centres, a Data Factory, a Software Factory and a shared AI platform.

- **IA : le Maroc engage une nouvelle phase de sa strategie nationale a l'horizon 2030** — PanoraPost, 9 September 2026

  Morocco's Ministry of Digital Transition and Administrative Reform presented progress on its "Maroc IA 2030" roadmap in Rabat, including a sovereign AI marketplace, an AI assistant for the Idarati portal and a national e-wallet proof of concept. The roadmap targets 100 billion dirhams of added GDP, 50,000 jobs and 200,000 trained people by 2030.

- **Maroc IA 2030 : le Royaume passe de l'ambition a l'action** — LesEco.ma, 10 September 2026

  Summarised under Data Storage.

JAZARI ARTIFICIAL-INTELLIGENCE INSTITUTES

- **Les assemblees generales de quatre Instituts 'JAZARI' se sont tenues le 8 septembre 2026 a Rabat, sous la presidence de Madame la Ministre Amal El Fallah Seghrouchni** — Ministere de la Transition Numerique et de la Reforme de l'Administration, 8 September 2026

  Morocco's four JAZARI artificial intelligence institutes held their general assemblies in Rabat on 8 September 2026, chaired by the digital transition minister, Amal El Fallah Seghrouchni. Their founding conventions were approved in the Bulletin officiel in August 2026. JAZARI ROOT covers digital infrastructure, data centres, computing and national AI capability; the others cover education, industry and smart cities.

NATIONAL ARTIFICIAL-INTELLIGENCE ROADMAP "MOROCCO AI 2030"

- **Les principales avancees de la feuille de route Maroc IA 2030 presentees a Rabat** — Maroc.ma (Portail national du Maroc) / MAP, 8 September 2026

  Morocco's digital transition ministry presented the main advances of the Maroc IA 2030 roadmap in Rabat, framing it as the move from design into implementation. The minister-delegate said the national AI conference had been the founding stage and that the AI Made in Morocco roadmap now enters a phase of concrete delivery.

RAIL OPERATOR'S NATIONAL AI VIDEO-SURVEILLANCE SYSTEM

- **ONCF prépare un dispositif national de vidéosurveillance dopé à l'IA pour 2030** — Journal Du Canada, 10 September 2026

  Morocco's national rail operator, ONCF, issued a 1.08 million dirham tender for a study to design a national video-surveillance system with AI analytics and central supervision by 2030, reported on 10 September 2026. The study will size cameras, data storage, transmission networks and supervision centres for later procurement. No budget for the full system has been announced.

DIGITAL MINISTRY PARTNERSHIP WITH MISTRAL AI

- **Morocco, Mistral AI release first open-source AI tools under AI made in Morocco roadmap** — Tech Review Africa, 29 September 2026

  Morocco's digital ministry and Mistral AI released their first open-source tools: a classifier that tells Arabic dialects including Darija apart, and a speech-recognition model for Darija that handles switching into French and English.

- **Le ministère de la Transition numérique et Mistral annoncent les premières briques d'IA développées | Maroc.ma** — Maroc.ma (Government of Morocco), 30 September 2026

  Morocco's digital transition ministry and Mistral released the first open-source tools from their AI partnership: a classifier that distinguishes Arabic dialects including Darija, and a Voxtral speech-recognition model for Darija that handles switching between Arabic, French and English. The ministry says further language and public-service models are in development.

Innovation ecosystem

FONDS CATALYTIQUE STARTUPS

- **Feu vert a Tamwilcom pour investir 347 MDH dans les startups** — Entreprises du Maroc, 10 September 2026

  Morocco's government authorised Tamwilcom, by decree 2.26.576 of 3 August 2026, to invest up to 347 million dirhams over three years in venture capital funds on behalf of the Fonds Catalytique Startups, under the Digital Morocco 2030 strategy. Nine fund managers were pre-selected, covering fintech, agritech, edtech, healthtech and climate tech. The funds are expected to raise close to 2.5 billion dirhams for startups.

- **Digital : 347 millions de dirhams en appui au financement des startups au Maroc (ministere)** — H24Info, 11 September 2026

  Morocco's startup catalytic fund, run by the digital transition ministry and managed by Tamwilcom, can invest 347 million dirhams over three years in venture capital funds backing digital startups, following decree 2.26.576 of 3 August 2026. Nine management companies have been shortlisted, and the funds are expected to raise about 2.5 billion dirhams.

- **Morocco targets $258 million in startup financing through new venture capital mechanism** — The Morocco Post, 14 September 2026

  Morocco's Startup Catalytic Fund, set up by the digital transition ministry and managed by Tamwilcom, will invest US$36m of public money over three years in venture capital funds expected to mobilise about US$258m for startups. Decree 2.26.576 of 3 August 2026 strengthened its framework, and nine fund managers were shortlisted from 47 applications.

Capacity

Training and skills

GÉNÉRATION AIOT TRAINING PROGRAMME

- **Le programme Génération AIoT vise 1 200 talents formés par an dès février 2027** — Consonews, 13 September 2026

  Morocco's Génération AIoT programme opened seven cohorts in Casablanca, Fès and Oujda, aiming at 1,200 trained people a year from February 2027. Launched in February 2026 by the digital transition ministry with a foundation and ABA Technology, it had drawn 2,118 applications and gathered 95 participants.

CIVIL-SERVICE DIGITAL TRAINING PARTNERSHIP (ENA AND ADD)

- **ENA and ADD join forces to make Morocco's government more digital** — 7News Morocco, 23 September 2026

  Morocco's National School of Administration and its Digital Development Agency signed a partnership on 22 September 2026 to train civil servants in digital transformation, AI, data management and change management. The number of officials to be trained and the programmes have not been announced.

EXECUTIVE LEADERSHIP PROGRAMME IN CYBERSECURITY

- **"Cyber Academy" Cybersecurity Training Program for African Leaders Kicks off in Rabat** — Maroc.ma (MAP), 6 October 2026 AFRICA

  Morocco's General Directorate of Information Systems Security and the World Bank, with the Smart Africa Digital Academy, opened the Cyber Academy executive training programme in Rabat on 5 October 2026 for leaders of African cybersecurity authorities. It covers strategic leadership, AI-driven threats and cyber crisis response. No participant numbers are given.

Research institutions

ADAPTVOTE OFFLINE-CAPABLE E-VOTING RESEARCH PROTOTYPE

- **"تجربة مغربية للتصويت الرقمي تجمع التعرف على الوجه و"البلوك تشين** — Hespress, 7 September 2026

  Researchers at Mohammed I University in Oujda and Abdelmalek Essaâdi University in Tétouan tested AdaptVote, an e-voting model combining facial recognition and blockchain, with 300 people in Nador over 12 hours. The network was available for only 35% of the trial; 95.7% passed identity checks first time and voting took 2.1 minutes against 4.5 on paper. It is a research platform, not an official system.

DOMESTIC AI RESEARCH ON CLIMATE ADAPTATION

- **المغرب يوسع أبحاث الذكاء الاصطناعي لمواجهة مخاطر الإجهاد المائي** — Hespress, 10 September 2026

  A scientific review available from 1 September records an expansion of Moroccan research applying artificial intelligence to drought, water scarcity and rising temperatures. It covers forecasting tools, resource monitoring, irrigation, and the management of energy and heat inside cities, across water, agriculture, energy, cities and natural hazards.

Inclusion

Access to services

DISABILITY DATA AND ACCESS MEASURES

- **Morocco disability rate rises to 8.7% as access gaps persist** — Hespress English, 3 September 2026

  Morocco's third national disability survey puts disability prevalence at 8.7% of the population, up from 6.8% in 2014, according to preliminary results presented in Rabat on 3 September 2026. The survey covered 20,412 households; only 20% of disabled people reported internet access, and their employment rate was 12.7%. Officials said broader detection tools account for part of the increase.

USE OF AND TRUST IN SOCIAL PLATFORMS

- **86% من المغاربة يستخدمون منصات التواصل و'واتساب' في الصدارة** — Assabah, 4 September 2026

  Sonergia's seventh annual social media barometer for Morocco found 86% of the population using social platforms in 2026, five points above 2025. WhatsApp leads at 83%, followed by Facebook at 64%, while TikTok rose eight points to 32%. Only 39% of Moroccans trust news circulating on the platforms outside official media, against 61% who express some distrust.

Digital divides

NIGHT-TIME NETWORK OUTAGES IN THE BEN CHERRO DOUARS, BENI MELLAL

- **(AR) Phone network cut at night in Ben Cherro douars, Beni Mellal: residents complain of a 'digital isolation' lasting until morning** — Al Omk Al Maghribi, 17 September 2026

> Residents of thirteen douars in the Ben Cherro area of Morocco's Beni Mellal province say phone service cuts out nightly from about 8pm until morning, with internet throughput degraded over the same hours. They describe the consequences as sharpest in emergencies.

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